



Link to meeting recording: <https://vimeo.com/438894823/b33928f14a>

HCF

Case Study Webinar



THE
COTSWOLD
GROUP

Better, Informed



- My background
- An insurance 'customer centric model'
- Meant to sound 'low key' and empathic
- Psychology and Active Listening at it's heart
- The key - not what you say but HOW you say it
- Dignity and respect to the customer at all times



Incapacity Case Study

Broken Ribs following an Assault

From claim form, claimant reports:

- Pain from broken ribs. Taking oramorph 5-10ml every 5-6hrs.
- Able to perform light activities for short periods. Is allowed to drive, but doesn't due to pain.

Medical information:

OH reports

1. Pre absence – April 19 review with OH due to significant absence. Signed off with depression stress & Anxiety, taking mx and attending talking therapies. Struggling with day to day activities.
2. Feb 20: Absent with broken ribs. Experiencing lots of pain, taking strong pain killers. Can manage activities but cannot stay on feet. Advised that X-ray confirms ribs not yet healed. Mental Health under control.
3. March 20 – Continues to experience pain, stopped taking morphine now. Using OTC medication.
4. April 20 Ongoing pain recommenced morphine, managing daily chores, struggling to stand more than 30 minutes, mood effected.

Conversation Management Definition

‘Conversation Management is a **structured** technique designed to facilitate the creation of a working relationship with any interviewee - be they genuine or dishonest – to provide **maximum disclosure** and enable the **accurate capture** of detail’.



Conversation Management

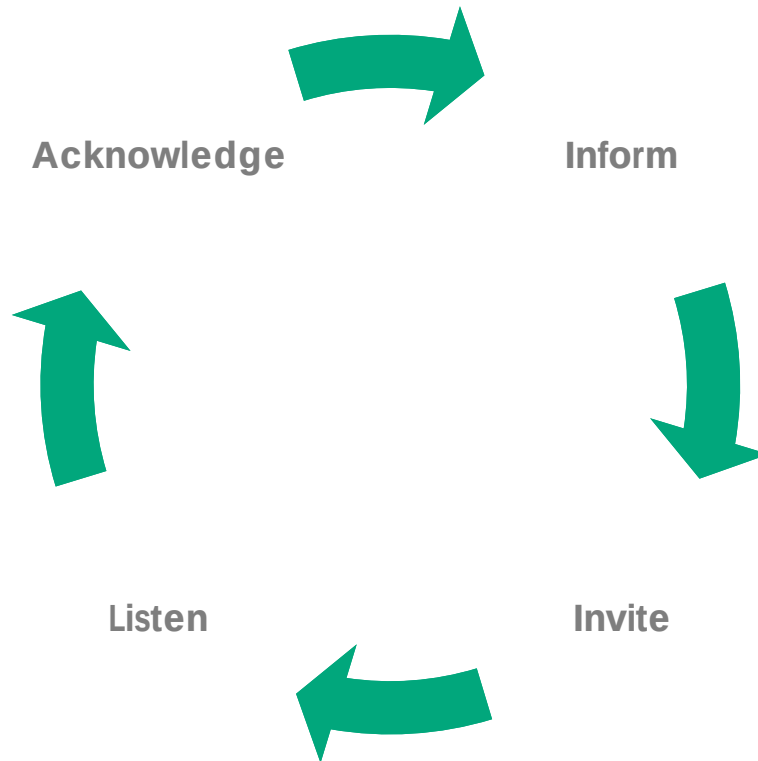


Common Observations

- Interrupting
- Voicing identified concerns too soon in the call and getting 'drawn in'
- Lack of call structure



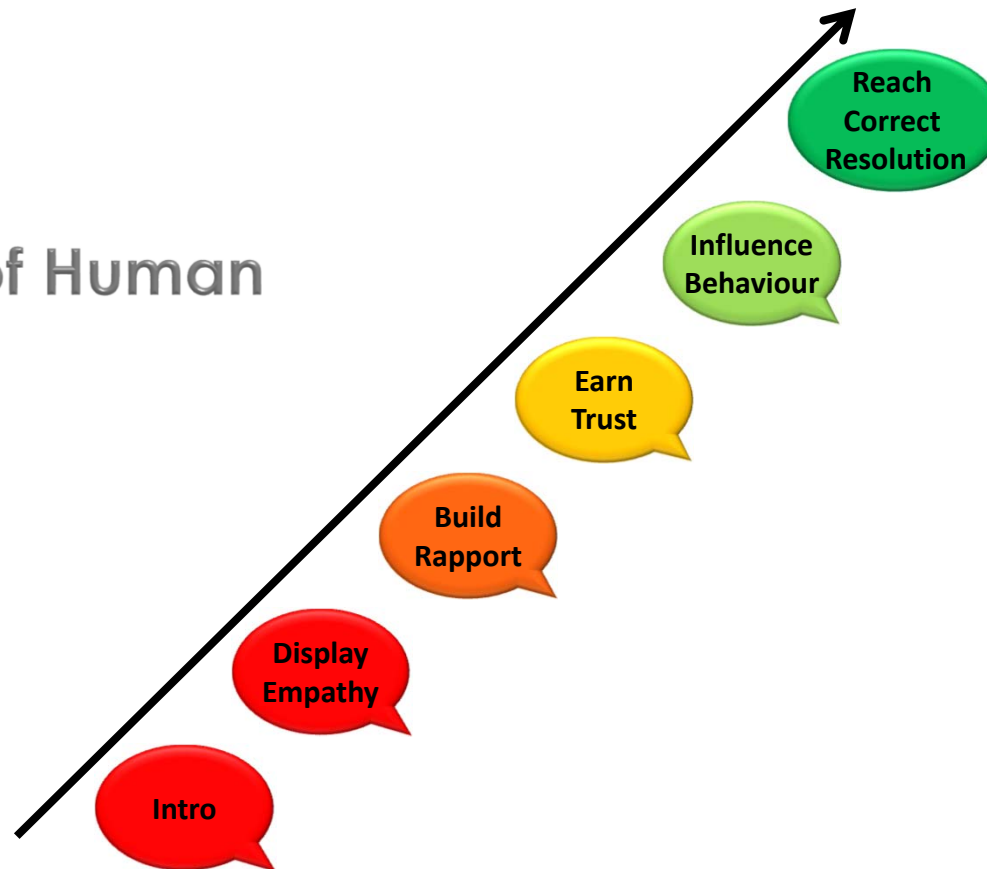
Conversation Cycle





**KEEP
CALM
AND
CHECK YOUR
TONE OF VOICE**

The Stairway of Human Psychology



Rapport Building and Empathy

- Explain what you are doing
- Listen without interfering/interrupting
- Use positive language and empathic tone
- Sound like you mean it! (even if you don't)
- Remember to pause effectively and LISTEN
- Use the customer's name and personalise their situation



Intelligence-Led Research

‘Lack of planning and preparation causes an exchange to be lost before it begins’





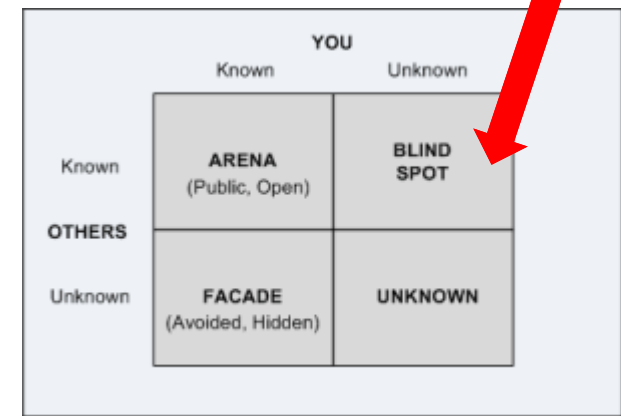
Start

Finish

-
- Chronological order of claim events
 - Very easy to use during your interaction with the claimant

Planning and Preparation

- Discipline is paramount - it gives you structure
- The Structure gives you freedom and confidence as VERY flexible
- It makes no sense to embark upon a 'conversation with a purpose' without first analysing the detail you have to hand (instruction papers and intel)
- What you know Vs what you need to know



Topics

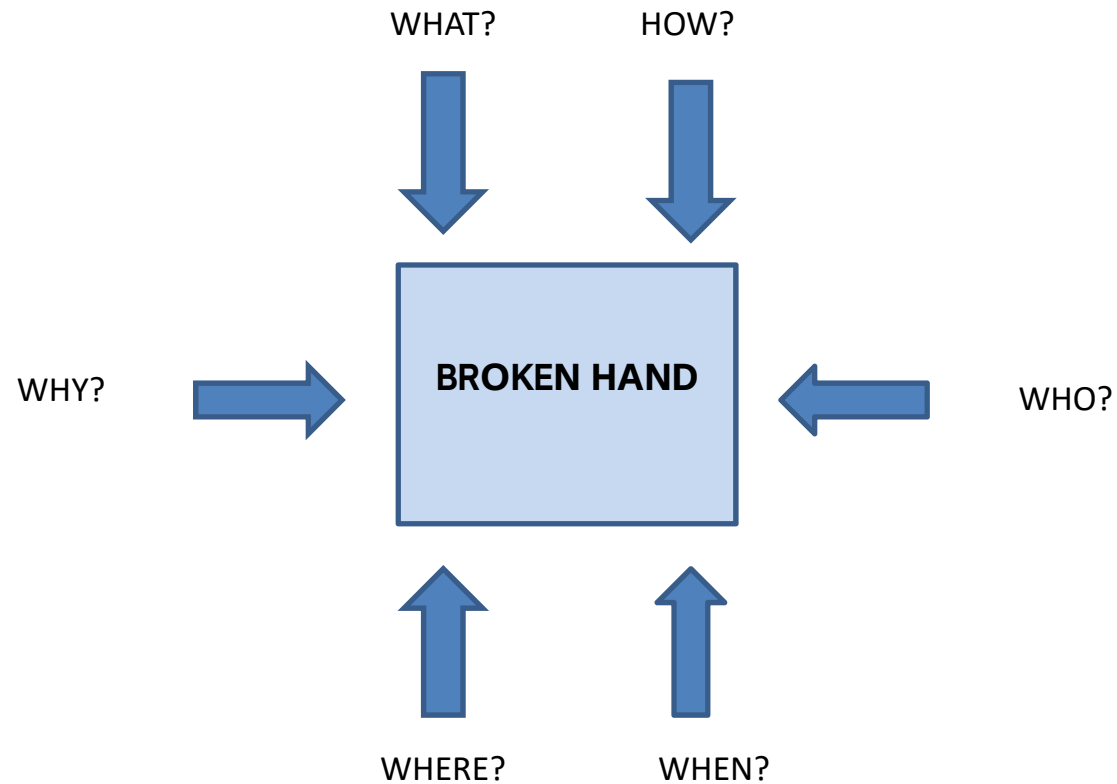


Topics

- Topics are 'events' or important points that **always** need more detail
- Topics are areas for you to explore with questioning
- Then fixes the detail into your working memory more effectively
- Ensures you don't miss fine detail whilst still sounding conversational



The 5 WH's



Invitational Question



- Please describe for me....
- Tell me about...

A **must** to open the conversation and begin understanding the timeline of the claim circumstances



Open Questions

“What...?”

“When...?”

“How...?”

“Where...?”

“Who...?”

A must for gathering information and probing

Closed Questions



“Did you...?”

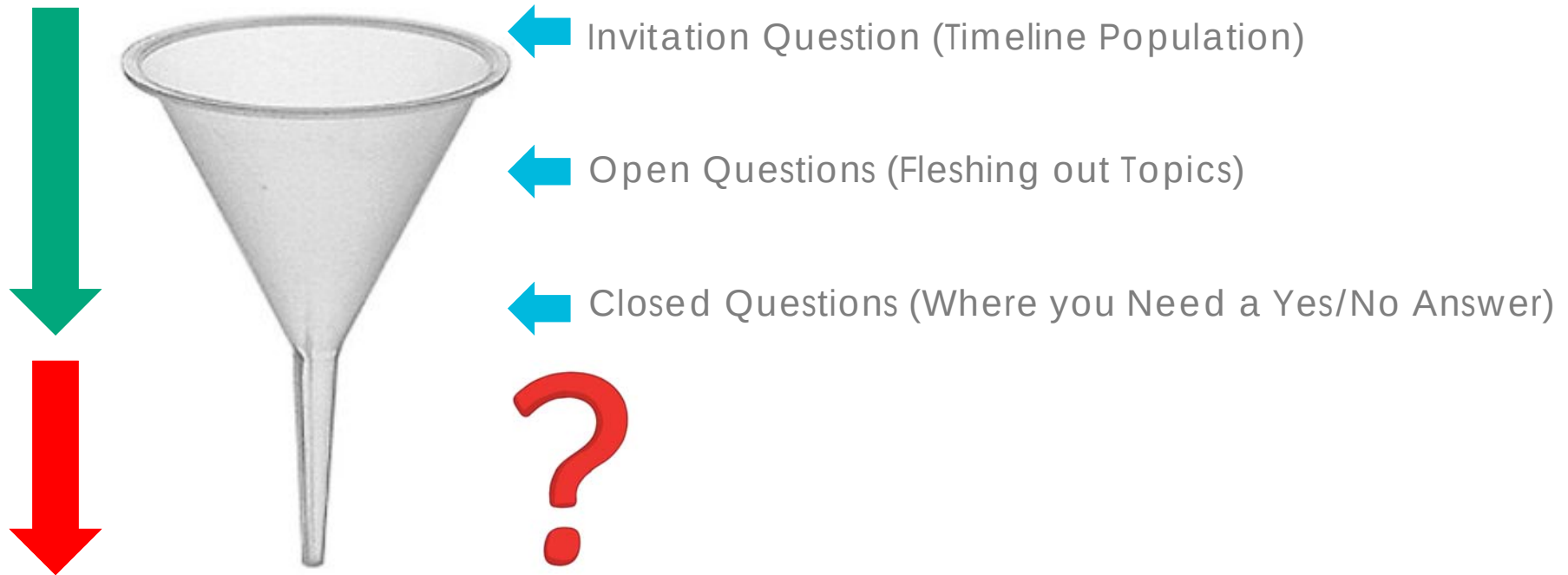
“Have you...”

“Will you...?”

Closed questions have the following characteristics:

- They give you facts
- They are easy and quick to answer
- They keep control of the conversation with the questioner
- These will always give you a closed option of yes or no

Has a crucial part to determine the smaller claim detail AFTER gaining information from open questioning



Active Listening Skills



Conversation Management Elements



Enhanced Soft Skills



Active Listening Skills

- Focuses on the real reason and purpose of the interaction
- Establishes rapport, relationships and influences behaviour
- Gathers information and intelligence
- Encourages behavioural change and secures the result you want

Active Listening (ALS) is the ONLY skill set designed to work towards all OF these goals at the same time!

**You will naturally be drawn to 2 or 3
techniques that work best for you**



Techniques of ALS

- Paraphrasing
- Pauses
- Emotion Labelling
- Echoing
- Minimal Encouragers
- Mirroring/Reflecting
- Silence
- Summarising



Minimal Encouragers – Elicits Information

- Brief responses/sounds that indicate you are listening.

Uh-huh?

Really?

Yes?

OK?

- Best used when the person is talking through **an initial account** or for an extended period of time.
- People want to know that you are there and listening.

Echo – Elicits Information

Quite simply, an 'echo' of the last word they said to encourage them to continue.

It elicits further expansion/information to be given.

“And that was it really, as soon as I said it he kicked off.”

“Kicked off?”

“Yes, I explained the situation and he just started shouting....”

Mirror – Elicits Information

Brief 'follow-alongs' by repeating **the last few words** to show you are listening.

Effective initial technique which helps you get orientated with the person during the initial stages of a call.

“He didn’t care that I couldn’t move and just left me there.”

“He left you there?”

“Yes, he left the house and I was on the floor unable to move for about 5 minutes....”



Paraphrasing – Builds Rapport

Putting the meaning in **your** own words:

‘A re-statement, giving the meaning in another form.’

Used for brief confirmations of meaning and to display attentiveness.

“He didn’t seem that bothered about the injury he caused to me.”

“You’re saying he didn’t take it seriously?”

Emotional Labelling – Builds Rapport

Statement of **emotions** heard:

This is a VERY effective method building rapport.....

“I’m so sorry, you sound frustrated by the need for us to understand what happened?”

“I can hear the upset in your voice...?”

But also a effective yet gentle way to display you have identified something of concern....

“You don’t sound so sure Alex?”

“You seem a little concerned Paul that we would need a copy of the medical records?”

Summarising – Clarifies Information

- Confirms our understanding of the detail provided
- Gives the customer a chance to make additions
- Ensures we haven't missed anything
- Provides the customer with confidence that we have listened

Effective Pauses and Silence

- Very powerful immediately **before or after** saying something meaningful
- Help focus thought and interaction
- Can also be an appropriate response to a full disclosure – it displays total engagement
- Great tool for listening for fraud indicators (stutters, hesitation)

The Case Study Broken Down

From reading the notes I already know there is a story here that we are currently not aware of....

Planning

- What do I know now?
- What do I need to know for the next stage?
- Always reach out for Claimant Profiling! Maybe she injuries are from something else?
- Once received, what topics do I need to populate with accurate information?
- How will I end this first call?
- What are my aims and objectives for this first call?
- Just gather information?
- Should I explain any concerns at the end of this call?
- **STRATEGY IS KEY!**

Structure

WHAT WHEN WHY WHO HOW WHERE 5			WHAT WHEN WHY WHO HOW WHERE 5
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Topics

1. Timeline of events to start with (confirms initial detail correct and allows you time to build rapport and actively listen, work for their trust!)

'Can you go nice and slow and in your own time explain what happened please?'

2. Topics I want to get fine detail on:

- ✓ Occupation
- ✓ Previous 3 year injuries/illness history before April 2019
- ✓ April 2019 absence – anxiety/depression
- ✓ Home situation at this time
- ✓ February 2020 broken ribs incident
- ✓ Immediate actions
- ✓ Hospital
- ✓ GP
- ✓ Affect on mental health
- ✓ Medication/dosage etc etc

Human Skills Approach

- Pace
- Tone must always be empathic (even if someone is painful!)
- Use human terminology such as '*please, there is no rush, just take your time*'
- Never interrupt or appear judgemental
- Conversation Cycle adherence
- Its not what you say but HOW you say it
- Use of their name brings you closer together
- Never patronise (i.e. I know how you feel) but use positive Emotional Labelling instead
- Self-discipline to these rules paramount (never skip a step)

EXAMPLE CLAIMS STRATEGY

1. Claims comes in
2. Sent for Claimant Profiling – you MUST look under each stone to gain full visibility
3. You complete information capturing Call 1 (as per this session)
4. Any claims that possess concerns, assign for us to carry out Call 2 and you work on those without concerns
5. You are not on your own! If it feels too difficult, send it to me – we are here to support you!

Questions?

Tara Shelton
Global Head of Desktop Solutions
The Cotswold Group
Mobile: +44 (0) 7515 556513
Email: Tara.Shelton@thecotswoldgroup.co.uk



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